

this option to 'true'.

DNSOverHTTPS: Set *Enabled* to 'false' because this is an excuse to send data to Cloudflare. What? You do not trust your ISP? Who is paranoid now?

DontCheckDefaultBrowser: Set this option to 'true'. If you are running multiple browsers or profiles, YOU should manually set the default browser.

Home page

URL: Set this to an empty string. No home page means faster loads.

Locked: Set this option to 'true'. Don't let a browser update mess with these settings.

StartPage: Set this to 'none'. No distractions. No tracking. No delays.

ManualAppUpdateOnly: Set this option to 'true' to prevent Firefox from checking or downloading updates.

NetworkPrediction: Set this option to 'false' to prevent Firefox from making unnecessary queries.

NoDefaultBookmarks: Set this option to 'true'. Less clutter.

OverrideFirstRunPage: Set this to an empty string. The first thing that Firefox does after is contact Mozilla with details of your installation.

OverridePostUpdatePage: Set this to an empty string. We are not going to the doctor, so no need to send us a bill.

PDFjs: How many avatars does it have? Set *Enabled* to 'false'.

Permissions: Browsers can now access your microphone and web camera. The latter has an indicator that lights up when it is being accessed. The microphone has nothing. Block everything, unless you need to do teleconferencing. If you are not recording anything, put some black tape on the web cam. In your computer's audio configuration settings, enable only the output devices. That will disable the microphone (an input device) at the OS level.

Camera: Set *BlockNewRequests* and *Locked* to true. Do the same for *Microphone*, *Location*, *Notifications* and *VirtualReality*.

Autoplay: Prevent videos in unopened tabs from playing automatically. If you open multiple tabs, the videos can lock up your bandwidth and also kill your browser/tab process. Set *Default* to 'block-audio-video' and *Locked* to 'true'.

Preferences: These are *about:config* settings that you can automatically set from this JSON file.

- **browser.safebrowsing.*.enabled:** Set these options to 'false'. No need to verify every requested domain or file with Google for a malware check. Do not visit bad sites and do not click on bad downloads. You are on your own now.
- **browser.sessionstore.resume_from_crash:** Set this option to 'false'. You do not want a banking website to reload

after a crash.

- **browser.tabs.closeWindowWithLastTab:** I wonder if Chrome kills itself when you close the last tab. I bet it stays on till kingdom come. Firefox just uses any excuse to quit on you. What if you wanted to open new tabs from a clean slate? Set this option to 'false'.
 - **dom.event.clipboardevents.enabled:** This setting is useful on sites that let you copy URLs or some other important text with just a click instead of a *Ctrl+C* on a text selection. Some other sites take this opportunity to add unwanted text such as their site name and URL into the copied text. Set this option to 'false' if you get annoyed by the spammers.
 - **dom.event.contextmenu.enabled:** Some sites, particularly those run by a few Indian banks, block the right-click menu. Set this option to 'true' if you want the menu.
 - **browser.search.suggest.enabled:** Just as you do not want search engines to track your searches, you should not know what others have been searching. It can get very disgusting, particularly with Google. Set this option to 'false'.
 - **media.mediasource.enabled:** Even though I now have high-speed internet, I cannot reliably stream videos. My video player box hangs in the middle of things. Instead of getting annoyed, I just go to a video channel, mass-download all interesting videos and then see them offline. I have a Greasemonkey script for this. It does not work if this setting is set to 'true'. There are add-ons that can download MediaSource videos too, but I prefer to do my own thing.
- NewTabPage:** You do not need this. What you need is *about:blank*. Set this option to 'false'.

SanitizeOnShutdown: Make Firefox automatically delete cookies, cache files, downloads list, history log, sessions and offline app data (an extended version of cookies) when it is closed.

SearchBar: Set this option to 'separate'. Otherwise, you will end up searching everything with just one search engine.

SearchSuggestEnabled: Search engines store everything you search, even your corrections. Set this option to 'false'.

UserMessaging: You be the judge and decide. Do not outsource your decision-making to marketers. Set *WhatsNew*, *ExtensionRecommendations*, *FeatureRecommendations*, *UrlbarInterventions*, *SkipOnboarding*, *MoreFromMozilla* to 'false'.

Hosts file

Having a 'blocking' *hosts* file is the most effective way to reduce the environmental footprint of your browsing activity. Java scripts from social media sites and advertising are the #1 reason for the slowness of web pages. When you use a blocking *hosts* file, the content delivery domains of these sites are pointed back to your computer. Your computer just says 'not found' and the browser abandons those requests.